Category Policy Addendum: Home & Kitchen

KARTWAY OPERATIONAL POLICY ADDENDUM: HOME & KITCHEN Document ID: POL-HK-409 Effective Date: 14 January 2025 Applies To: All Tier-1 and Tier-2 Customer Operations Agents, Returns Processing Centre Staff, and Seller Dispute Mediators Jurisdiction: India Operations Hub (Kartway Marketplace Services Pvt. Ltd.)

1.0 PURPOSE AND SCOPE This document establishes the binding operational rules for the processing of returns, refunds, hazardous handling, and warranty claims within the Home & Kitchen product category on the Kartway marketplace. In the event of a conflict between this addendum and general marketplace policy, the specific clauses contained herein shall take precedence for all Home & Kitchen SKUs.

2.0 RETURN WINDOWS AND ELIGIBILITY

2.1 Standard Return Window 1. The standard return window for all Home & Kitchen products is 30 days from the verified delivery date. 2. No extensions, grace periods, or manager overrides shall be applied beyond the 30 days threshold. Any return request initiated on or after day 31 from delivery must be automatically rejected by the support agent.

2.2 Change of Mind Returns (Opened Items) 1. Customers may return opened Home & Kitchen items due to a change of mind within the 30 days return window, subject to the deductions outlined in Section 3.0. 2. The item must not fall under the hazardous or perishable restriction list defined in Section 5.0.

2.3 Damaged, Defective, or Incorrect Items 1. Any Home & Kitchen item delivered damaged, incorrect, or defective must be reported by the customer within 30 days of the delivery date. 2. Reports exceeding 30 days from delivery for damage or defects shall be redirected to the manufacturer warranty process (see Section 6.0) and are ineligible for standard marketplace return.

3.0 FEES AND DEDUCTIONS FOR CHANGE OF MIND RETURNS

3.1 Restocking Fee 1. An opened Home & Kitchen item returned solely due to a change of mind carries a mandatory restocking fee of 10% of the total amount paid by the customer. 2. The 10% fee is calculated strictly on the final transaction value (item price minus applicable instant discounts, excluding shipping charges) and shall be automatically withheld from the refund disbursement.

3.2 Return Pickup Fee 1. For change of mind returns requiring a reverse logistics pickup, a flat return pickup fee of 99 rupees shall be levied. 2. The 99 rupees pickup fee is non-negotiable and shall be directly deducted from the final refund amount alongside the restocking fee specified in Clause 3.1. 3. For defective, damaged, or wrong items reported within 30 days, the 99 rupees pickup fee is waived entirely, and zero restocking fees apply.

4.0 PACKAGING REQUIREMENTS

4.1 Original Packaging Status 1. Original manufacturer packaging is not mandatory for returning Home & Kitchen items under this policy addendum. 2. Agents shall not reject a return request solely on the grounds that the outer carton, box, or shrink-wrap has been discarded or opened by the customer, provided the physical item meets the condition requirements stated in Section 2.0 and Section 5.0.

5.0 HAZARDOUS, SHARP, AND PERISHABLE HANDLING RULES

5.1 Cookware and Appliances 1. All returned cookware, pots, pans, and electrical kitchen appliances must be thoroughly cleaned of food residue, grease, or liquids and must be completely dry prior to handing them over to the reverse logistics pickup agent. 2. If an appliance or cookware item is presented to the pickup agent in an uncleaned, wet, or unsanitary condition, the pickup agent is authorized to refuse collection, and the support agent must log a failed pickup attempt.

5.2 Knives, Blades, and Sharp Instruments 1. All knives, cleavers, mandoline blades, peelers, and other sharp instruments must be returned safely enclosed inside a dedicated blade guard, rigid sleeve, or their original protective sheath. 2. Unprotected sharp blades presented for pickup represent a severe safety hazard to logistics personnel and must be rejected immediately by the pickup executive. Agents must instruct the customer to secure the blade in a hard cardboard sheath or protective housing before a secondary pickup is scheduled within the 30 days window.

6.0 WARRANTY POSITION AND CLAIMS

6.1 Warranty Duration 1. Home & Kitchen products do not carry a uniform marketplace warranty. Instead, products carry the specific warranty period shown explicitly on their own individual product listing page at the time of purchase. 2. Valid warranty durations are restricted strictly to none, 6, 12, or 24 months. 3. The warranty coverage period is counted strictly from the verified delivery date.

6.2 Warranty Claim Processing (Post-30 Days) 1. For claims raised after the expiration of the 30 days standard return window but within the active listing warranty period (6, 12, or 24 months), support agents must direct the customer to the authorized service center network listed on the product detail page or initiate a manufacturer-backed repair ticket. 2. Kartway operations will not issue direct cash or card refunds for warranty claims falling outside the initial 30 days window unless authorized in writing by the category merchant of record.

7.0 REFUND ISSUANCE SUMMARY MATRIX

Return Scenario	Reporting Deadline	Restocking Fee	Pickup Fee	Packaging Requirement	Refund Quantum
Change of Mind (Opened)	Within 30 days	10% of amount paid	99 rupees	Not mandatory	Total paid minus 10% and 99 rupees
Damaged, Wrong, or Defective	Within 30 days	0% (None)	0 rupees (Waived)	Not mandatory	100% Full refund
Warranty Claim (Post-Delivery)	6, 12, or 24 months (Per listing)	Per merchant terms	Per merchant terms	Per merchant terms	Repair, replacement, or pro-rata per warranty policy